Build Winamp.

Same prompt. Two frontier models. Real numbers.

- **Opus 5.5** `Claude Code · Ultra`

vs

- **GPT-6 Sol** `Codex · ultra`

One finished in 18 minutes. The other took 51. Guess which one looks more like the real Winamp.

SWIPE FOR THE NUMBERS →

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Real builds. Real numbers.

THE SETUP

One prompt. Word for word.

PROMPT (TRANSLATED, CONDENSED)

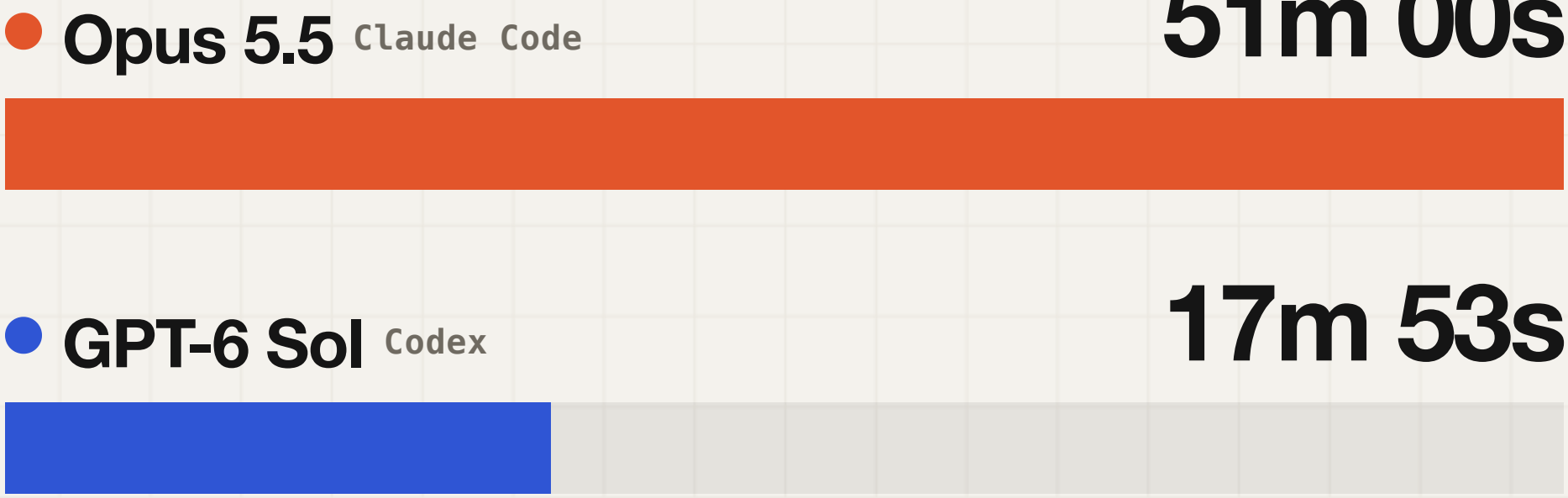
One self-contained HTML file: the closest visual and functional clone of classic Winamp 2.x. Main player, equalizer and playlist, docked. Pixel look, green LED display, no modern styling. Working transport, local files, seek, volume, balance, shuffle/repeat, playlist, 10-band EQ + presets (Web Audio), spectrum visualizer, window dragging, an embedded royalty-free track. Pure HTML/CSS/JS. No external requests, no dead buttons.

- ✓ **Same prompt, word for word (checked in the logs)**
- ✓ **Fresh session, empty folder**
- ✓ **Modes: Opus 5.5 · Ultra (logs: xhigh); GPT-6 Sol · ultra**
- ✓ **No follow-up messages during the run**
- ✓ **One run each (n=1)**
- ✓ **Time, tokens and cost pulled from the session logs**

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01 · TIME

GPT-6 Sol finished 2.9× faster.



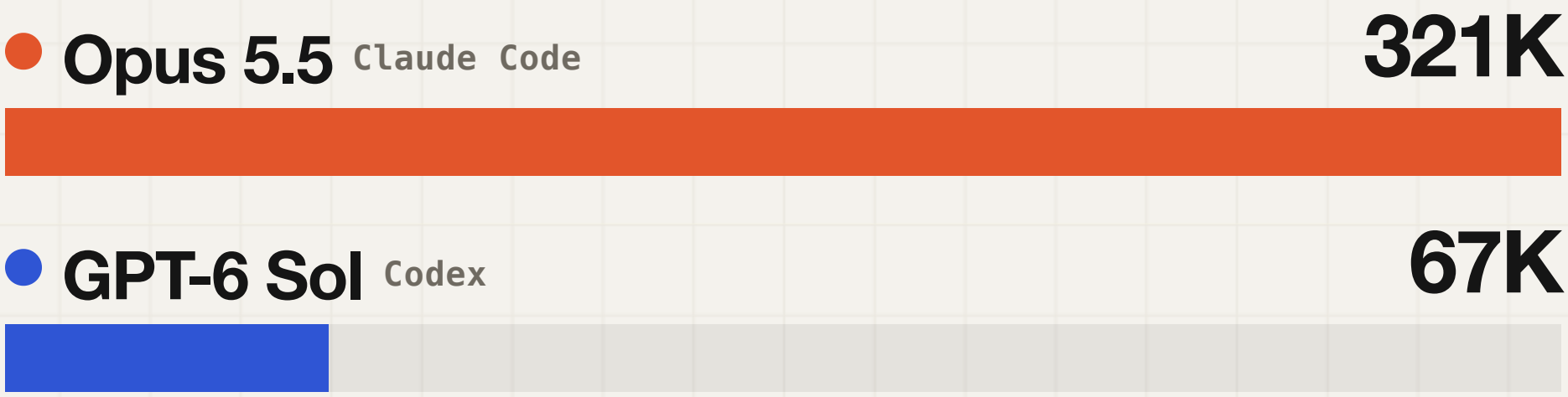
Wall-clock time from the prompt to the agent's final answer, pulled from session logs. Opus hit its output limit once and auto-resumed. No human input on either side.

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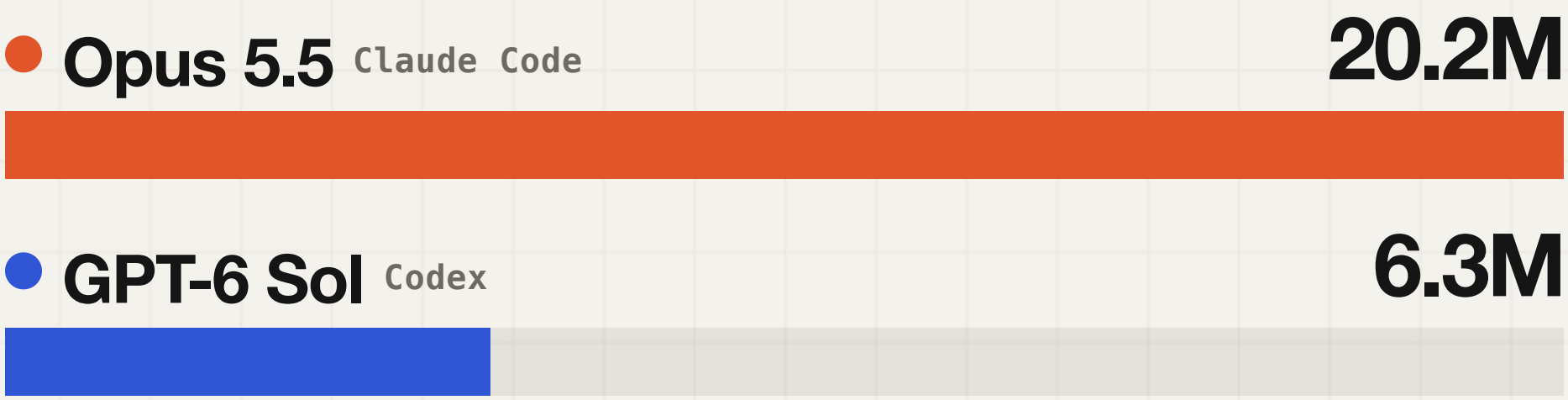
02 · TOKENS

Opus 5.5 generated 4.8× more output tokens.

OUTPUT (INCL. THINKING)



TOTAL PROCESSED (INCL. CACHED CONTEXT)



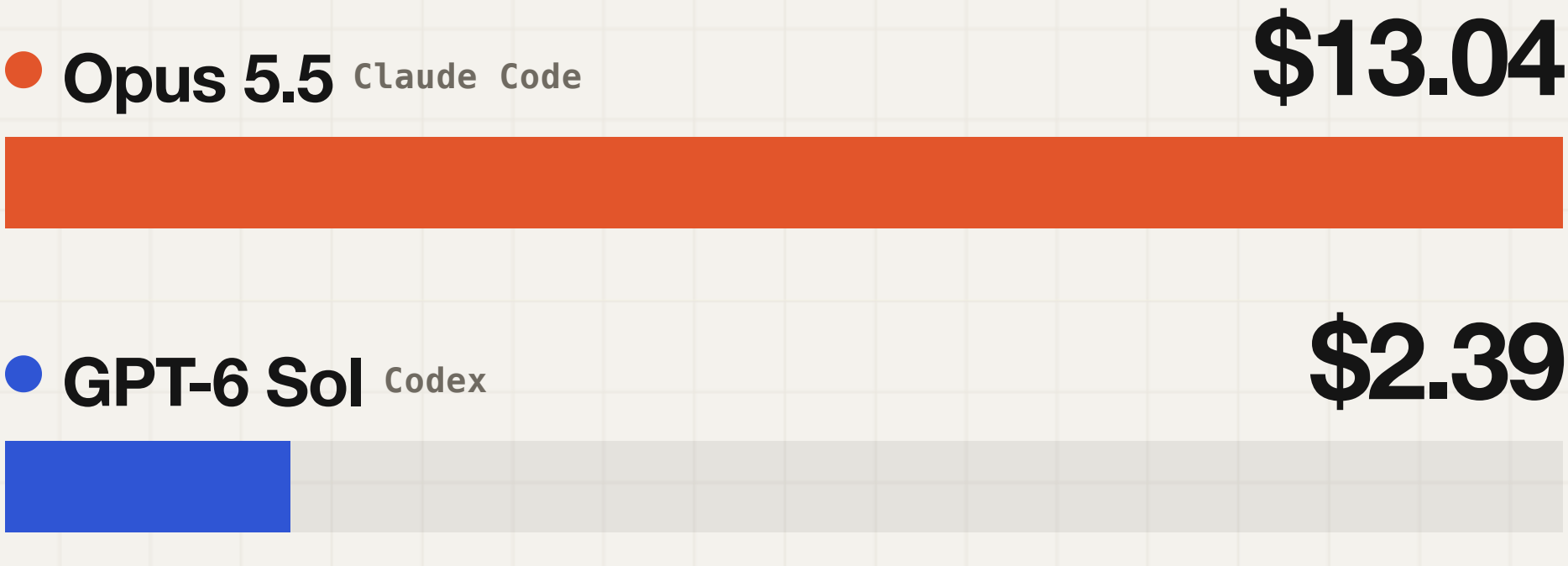
Output includes thinking/reasoning (Opus 157K, Sol 32K). Total = everything read and written, mostly cached context re-read at every step.

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Real builds. Real numbers.

03 · COST

GPT-6 Sol cost 5.5× less.



List prices per 1M tokens. Opus 5.5: $4 in / $20 out, cache reads $0.20. GPT-6 Sol: $2 in / $10 out, cached $0.20. I ran both on subscriptions, so this is the API-equivalent.

04 · HOW THEY WORKED

Same task. Two engineering styles.

Opus 5.5

Claude Code · Ultra

- Ultra mode on, sub-agents available — still worked solo
- Opened the app in a real browser and clicked through it to test
- Composed its own demo track with a script, encoded it to MP3
- Hit the output limit once and auto-resumed

API requests	69
Code written	~135 KB
Embedded audio	~1.5 MB

GPT-6 Sol

Codex · ultra

- Lead agent + 3 sub-agents: audio, reference audit, code audit
- Wrote a Python acceptance script to check the requirements
- A sub-agent generated the demo track
- An auto-reviewer checked its commands

API requests	99
Code written	~42 KB
Embedded audio	~2.1 MB

05 · THE CHECKLIST

What actually works.

	Opus 5.5	GPT-6 Sol
Three docked sections: player → EQ → playlist	✓	✓
Winamp 2.x look: pixels, green LED, no modern styling	✓	~
Transport buttons work	✓	✓
Loads local audio files	✓	✓
Timer + seek	✓	✓
Volume + balance	✓	✓
Shuffle + repeat	✓	✓
Playlist: add / remove / double-click to play	✓	✓
10-band EQ + preamp audibly works	✓	✓
EQ presets	✓	✓
Spectrum visualizer reacts to audio	✓	✓
Window dragging	✓	✓
No external requests, no dead buttons	✓	✓

✓ works · ~ partly · ✗ doesn't work — no points, no totals. Checklist taken straight from the prompt, fixed before scoring, 1 item dropped after scoring ("Embedded track plays on open": the prompt never asked for autoplay). Items without an automated test were judged by an AI agent from screenshots; I reviewed every mark.

06 · WHAT THEY BUILT

Here's what each one shipped.



Opus 5.5

Winamp clone with an authentic 2.x pixel/LED look; every check passed.



GPT-6 Sol

Working Winamp clone, faster and cheaper; only the UI reads more modern than 2.x-authentic.

MY TAKE

Both models shipped a working Winamp clone: transport, playlist, 10-band EQ and presets, volume/balance, spectrum visualizer, seek and window dragging all passed automated checks, with zero external requests and no dead buttons. Opus matched the authentic Winamp 2.x pixel/LED look; Sol's gradients and smoothed fonts read as more modern.

What should I test next?

Drop a task in the comments. The most-liked one becomes Build-Off #002.

n=1 · one run each · 2026-09-23 · "Ultra" isn’t the same knob: Claude Code = xhigh effort + orchestration, Codex = top reasoning effort · a field test, not a benchmark

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